

of this Tips and Tricks section. If you have an Xposed framework installed already, you could simply search for this module and download it, or go to <http://dgit.in/XposedSSPB> for the documentation.

Use advanced reboot options

Advanced Power Menu is an Xposed module that includes advanced reboot options such as reboot, soft reboot and reboot to recovery, as well as a screenshot option in the power menu of your Android device. You can switch between several power menu options like Anti-theft helper (ATH), Hide ATH description, Fake power off etc., which are distinct from each other. To download this Xposed module, go to: <http://dgit.in/XposedAPM>. Once you install the module, it will prompt you to reboot your Android device for changes to take effect.

GIVE OLD HARDWARE A NEW LEASE OF LIFE

All your shiny new gadgets get special attention, leaving the old tech collecting dust in a corner. Although these old gadgets can still serve a purpose, they remain unnoticed. Even though the technology may be obsolete, we can still eke out a few more months/years from the hardware. Here are some of the best tips and tricks to give your old hardware a new lease of life.

Turn your old router into a wireless repeater

Your old unused wireless router can be put back into action by using it as a range extender. Some routers offer this functionality directly and will serve our purpose without any hassle. However, if your router doesn't offer this functionality you'll

Manufacturer	Model	Revision	Supported	Activation required
Asus	RT-N13U	-	yes	no
Asus	RT-N13U	B1	yes	no

Check for "yes" under the supported column.

have to perform a few steps to make it work.

This includes replacing your router's factory firmware with a Linux-based 'DD-WRT' custom firmware. Not all routers support DD-WRT firmware so before going further, check whether your router is present in the compatibility list at <http://dgit.in/supportddwrt>

Note: It's recommended that you not proceed further if your router is not in the list. A similar device on the list doesn't mean that you have support either, so be wary and always ensure that you have full support before proceeding with anything.

If your router is in the database, download the latest release. Follow the guide offered on DD-WRT's website for your router and install the custom firmware. After you've successfully installed DD-WRT, open the router's control panel by firing 192.168.1.1 in the address bar of your browser.

Go to Wireless > Basic Settings > Choose 'Repeater' for wireless mode > Enter the SSID of your primary router > Choose 'Bridged' for network connections > Hit Save > Apply.

Then, go to Setup > Basic Setup > Change the router's IP address (to be on the same subnet as the primary router). If this method isn't working for you, refer to the official DD-WRT guide at <http://dgit.in/wlanrepeater>.

Turning your PC or laptop into a media server

Another great use of your old laptop or PC is as an always-on media server. This will let you stream media content directly from the old machine onto your HDTV or any device without needing to copy the content on a USB drive.

There are many applications that let you do this; unfortunately, most of them are paid apps. Let's look at a free alternative - 'FreeNAS'. FreeNAS is an operating system that offers Network Attached Storage (NAS) services. It can be downloaded from <http://dgit.in/freeNAS>

Once downloaded, burn and install it on your old PC (you can use USB installation if your PC supports it). After installation, move on to network configuration which includes choosing the Ethernet port from the list and setting up a LAN IP address (use DHCP unless you're using static IP). Once that's done, a URL will be provided that can be used to manage and control the NAS from another computer on the same network.

Note: You don't need a monitor, keyboard and mouse attached to the old computer anymore. You can disconnect them and manage your NAS from any other computer on the same network.

On the computer from which you'll be controlling the NAS, load the URL in a browser and you'll be straightaway taken to

the control panel of your newly setup NAS. To create a media server you'll have to enable UPnP. This can be done by navigating to Services > UPnP > Check 'Enable'.

Following this, give your server a name, choose the database directory (this is just a directory that stores the UPnP configuration file) and add the folder that contains the media content you want to stream. If you want to stream to PlayStation or Xbox, check 'Enable transcoding' as well. Finally hit 'Save and Restart'.

Your server is now up and running. On your TV or any other device, search for the NAS server and it will appear with the name that you just provided.

Turning your tablet into a photo frame

You can use your antiquated Android tablet as a photo frame and take your living room's standard to a whole new level. All you have to do is wall mount your tablet and run a photo slideshow. Many apps let you do this. Our favourite is the 'Day-frame' app, which is available for free on the Google Play Store <http://dgit.in/dayframeapp>

One thing that we loved about this app is its social network synchronisation. In addition to the photos stored on your tablet, it displays photos from Facebook, Twitter and Instagram, as well as various services such as 500px, Tumblr,



Check "Enable" to start UPnP services